



1.b) Sects and Cults

The study of sects and cults is studied in relation to various denominations cropping out of ^{any} religions

Sects

- 1) Breaks away from larger religious group
- 2) claim monopoly of truth
- 3) Do not need a charismatic leader
- 4) Highly Closed system
member of one sect can't be in many sects at once
- 5) Ex:
Sikhism - Namahkari,
Nirankari
Islam - Shia, Sunni

Cults

- 1) forms within a particular religion still attached to it
- 2) all pluralistic in nature - can accept views
- 3) Rely heavily on a charismatic leader
- 4) Very open: members of many cults
- 5) Ex: Sadguru
Brahmakumar

	Respect society norms	Deviant
uniquely legitimate	Church	sect
pluralistically legitimate	denomination	cult

Reasons of formation :

- 1) Relative deprivation
- 2) political patronage
- 3) Cultural differences
- 4) Economic backwardness.

Zigmen Bourne: Rise of moral experts :
In want of specialised religion there are more & more newer outgrowths of religion.